



APLMUN GAZETTE

Issue No. 11

11th & 12th July, 2026

FOREWORD



It is with great pleasure that we welcome you readers into our interpretation and showcase of the vibrant discussions and the memorable moments that shaped the conference this year. Without the diligent preparation of the Secretariat, Executive Board, the Heads of School and the Organising Committee, the 11th edition of APLMUN would not have been the stellar occasion it has been. This year encompasses 5 committees - UNHRC, ECOSOC, UNSC, NATO and IPC - and while this year the event is more intimate in scale, the delegates have buckled down with razor-sharp focus, rapid exchanges, and refined perspectives that were expounded upon. We hoped to interact more closely with delegates and the executive board this year and gain a lot more insight into the proceedings with building the pillars of resolutions that can benefit our world today. Our highly proficient reporters aspire to entertain you all with their creative spin on the events inside the tensed yet keen atmospheres

of the committee rooms, and our thorough photographers leave no details spared with a plethora of candid and dynamic shots. This year, on behalf of the whole team, we hope that you derive inspiration and interest from what we have to say, and that you enjoy partaking what we have made for you as much as we enjoyed working in tandem to make it.

Happy reading!

Written by
Bhruhati Venkataramanan, editor in chief
Photography by
Divyan, Ruthva Harish and Shreyathi

“Prioritise precision over speed.”

- Amudha Lakshmanan,
Organising Committee
Head

“Everything seems impossible until its done.”

-Aarav Karthikeyan
Deputy Organising Committee Head

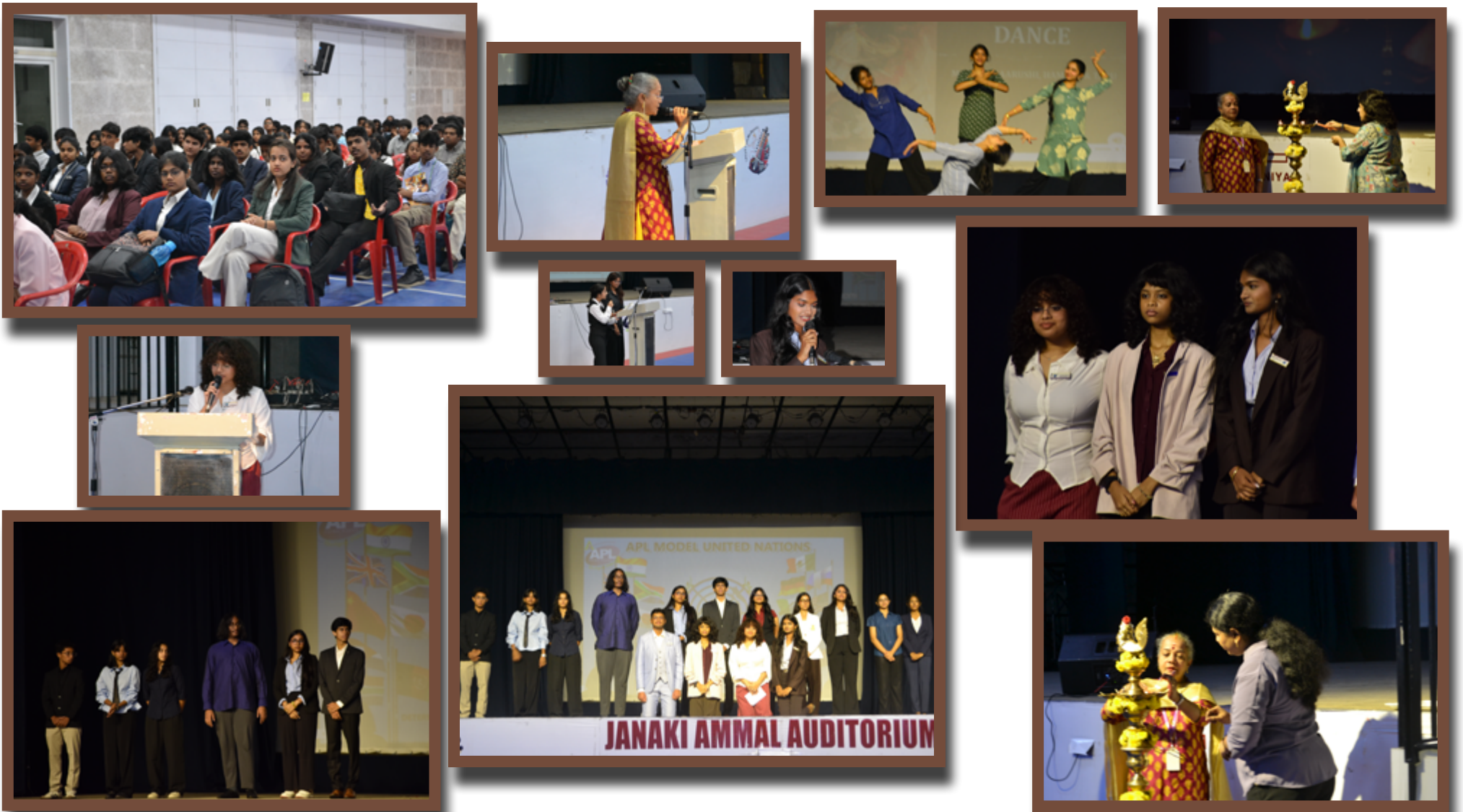
“When you unite with like minded, passionate individuals, the results of the work you do together is truly beautiful

-Bhruhati
Editor-in-Chief

“Cheers to a better circuit onwards”

-Alveena Arif,
Deputy Secretary General

Opening Ceremony



This year's MUN opened with a confluence of fortuitous beginnings, impeccably attired delegates, and authentic speeches that resonated with all those present. Welcoming 204 delegates this year, this event began on an auspicious note; the lamp was lit with fire by Sarija and Fiza ma'am and lit with passion by the delegates, signalling a momentous occasion with many more to come.

Following this was what people awaited with bated breath, the invocation dance. Eliciting the lithe movements of four exceptionally talented dancers, the awe of the performance set people at ease for the fast paced debates to come, and it ensured a smooth beginning to the proceedings of the first day.

The tone for the conference was then set with the enlightening keynote speech delivered by our esteemed Principal, Ms Sarija Santhosh. Her speech encompassed the importance of good leadership and attributes like empathy and confidence that build the rising generation's fortitude to take on global challenges and that we should take it in our hearts to partake in those values.

In the next part of the ceremony, we were introduced to the exemplary Secretariat and Executive Board members, and they were duly lauded for their unwavering dedication. Building to the pinnacle of the inaugural ceremony, we listened to the speeches of Amudha Lakshmanan, the OC head and Haasini Padmanabhan, the Secretary-General - whose refreshing and humorous speeches were a genuine salute to the hard work of their team.

Before everyone knew it, the gavel was brought down and this marked the beginning of two days charged with anticipation and intrigue.

Written by Bhruhati Venkataramanan, editor in chief
Photography by Ruthva Harish and Shreyathi Sai Shivakumar



Day 1

AGENDA: Evaluating the impact of unilateral coercive measures and regional escalations on the protection of civilian life and fundamental freedoms in relation to the current volatile geopolitical contexts

FREEZE DATE: 10th July 2026

MAJOR COUNTRIES: Germany, US, South Africa

The Human Rights Council is an intergovernmental body within the United Nations system responsible for strengthening the promotion and protection of human rights around the globe and for addressing situations of human rights violations and making recommendations on them.

The agenda for this session was, human rights implications of unilateral coercive measures with emphasis on regional escalations.

The committee remains divided along familiar lines. Developing and smaller member states have consistently argued that unilateral coercive measures, particularly sanctions, constitute a violation of the UN Charter and international human rights law, disproportionately harming civilian populations by restricting access to food, medicine, and essential goods.

Smaller delegations emphasized that sanctions imposed outside UN Security Council frameworks lack multilateral legitimacy. Speakers highlighted the humanitarian toll restricted medical imports and the collective punishment of populations for the actions of their governments. Several delegates called for exemptions for humanitarian goods and a shift toward targeted, transparent measures with clear clauses.

Larger and more economically developed states, led by the United States, defended sanctions as legitimate, targeted alternatives to armed forces that serve to deter aggression and human rights abuses while avoiding civilian harm when properly designed.

France argued for independent verification mechanisms involving multiple countries prior to any sanction decision, with safeguards to protect healthcare and non combatants. The United States stressed that sanctions can be lawful alternatives to force but warned against overly broad measures disrupting access to food, medicine, financial services, and aid delivery; the US specifically called for expanded licensing mechanisms

to ensure unimpeded humanitarian access. South Africa offered a historically grounded three pronged approach, a UN backed monitoring mechanism, secure standardized financial channels for humanitarian assistance, and increased multilateral dialogue to constrain unilateral actions.



Delegations across blocs expressed willingness to collaborate on accountability mechanisms and regular review processes to assess humanitarian impacts.

Key outcomes included France committing to resolution language on independent verification, the US advancing humanitarian exemptions and licensing frameworks, and South Africa formalizing its three-pronged proposal.

The session effectively balanced principles with practical mechanisms, though the quality of debate was uneven; several delegations relied heavily on AI-generated content, producing repetitive and generic positions that diluted the depth of discussion. Moving forward, the committee must assign named lead delegations to each proposal, establish specific timelines, and define measurable criteria for monitoring humanitarian impact, turning principled consensus into actionable, verifiable measures rather than hollow, algorithmically produced commitments.

Written by Hariny

Photography by Shreyathi

FEEDBACK

“Good MUN, great food, I like my co-EB”

- *Vihaan Reddy,*
NATO Co-Chair

“Confusing committee, but the first timers are confident and they’re participating which is rare. Also, amazing food and co-EB.”

- *Sarang Deepak Rajagopaul,*
NATO co-chair

“Lots of first-timers, in this MUN, not just in NATO, but good, well-researched speeches. Rooms are conditioned, with lots of resources available to use for the EB.”

- *Dhruva Ram,*
NATO co-chair

“Come to APL MUN for the pasta”

- *Sai Smriti,*
UNHRC co-chair

“After EB feedback, the delegates lowkey improved a lot. Also day 1 pasta was so goated.”

- *Sai Smriti,*
UNHRC co-chair

“Discussion and knowledge is great, but empathy is what solves the problem”

- *Haasini Padmanabhan,*
Secretary-General

“Lots of unexpected delegates shined on day 2, APLMUN is an event for growth.”

- *Abigail Albert,*
UNSC co-chair



Day 2

The next session commenced with a moderated caucus on strengthening systems of humanitarian aid transportation to ensure that essential supplies reach civilians affected by unilateral coercive measures. Delegates emphasized that sanctions should not obstruct access to food, medicine, and other necessities, with many advocating for stronger humanitarian exemptions and greater multilateral cooperation under the United Nations Charter.

During this discussion, economic sanctions were the key topic. Iran argued sanctions have caused significant humanitarian consequences, citing restricted access to essential medicines including cancer treatments, and maintained that such measures disproportionately affect civilians. The U.S. defended sanctions as a legitimate diplomatic tool, asserting that targeted measures and humanitarian exemptions minimize civilian suffering while holding governments accountable. Both countries stressed the need to balance political objectives with humanitarian obligations.

The most notable exchange was between Cuba and the US where Cuba criticized unilateral sanctions, accusing the U.S. of violating state sovereignty and international law, arguing they disproportionately harmed civilians. The U.S. reaffirmed that sanctions target governments, not civilians, and emphasized accountability and humanitarian safeguards - highlighting the divide between supporters of unilateral measures and advocates of multilateral approaches.

Proceeding this was a session dedicated entirely to feedback from the Executive Board regarding the delegates' deviation from their countries' official foreign policies, reliance on repetitive arguments, and the proposals of arguments beyond UNHRC's mandate. Delegates were encouraged, like in previous sessions, to justify their positions using international legal frameworks, engage in stronger rebuttals, and develop realistic, committee specific solutions.

Although no draft resolution was produced, the committee concluded with a general consensus on strengthening humanitarian protections and improving multilateral cooperation, setting the blueprint for Day 2's discourse.

The morning of day 2 had much in store where

speeches described the effects of UCM in different tones and consistency. France presented a moderate, policy-based view, supporting sanctions as a peaceful alternative to war while calling for UN assessment to reduce civilian harm. Iran strongly condemned unilateral sanctions as illegal and a form of collective punishment, arguing they violated human rights and exposed double standards. Switzerland focused on practical humanitarian transport, proposing systems to ensure aid actually reaches civilians. Afghanistan emphasized humanitarian exemptions, multilateral oversight, and diplomacy before coercive measures. Palestine delivered the most accusatory speech of the session, characterizing Israeli and US actions as constituting apartheid, the deliberate use of starvation, and the denial of due process. South Africa condemns unilateral sanctions as economic warfare that damages health, food and education.



Over the course of the committee, delegates progressed from unsurety to certainty as they conducted better background research and took greater initiative to speak and question dubious arguments. They slowly steered into a productive discussion, where the countries' views became clearer as their resolution took shape.

*Written by Hariny
Photography by Ruthva*



United Nations
Security Council

Day 1

AGENDA: Addressing the events unfolding in the current crisis in the Middle East

FREEZE DATE: 28th February 2026

MAJOR COUNTRIES: China, France, Russia, US, UK

The agenda for the Emergency Session (regarding the Crisis in the Middle East) intentionally does not name any specific countries, allowing the council to hold a broader discussion, including attacks to infrastructure, disruption to oil routes such as the Strait of Hormuz, and civilian harm. This elasticity allowed the crisis to be discussed as a regional emergency rather than a bilateral dispute. Though the agenda does not explicitly state the nuclear dispute, it is undoubtedly a major root cause with the collapsed US-Iran negotiation regarding Iran's Uranium Enrichment Program. The urgency to prevent the issue from spiraling into a war, is precisely why it is called an "Emergency Session". The session was requested on the same day as the strike, as the council's monthly sessions would not be able to handle the fast-paced nature of the situation. It also prevents the escalation of the situation and allows the council to touch on humanitarian and economical disputes, as these threaten regional peace and security.

On 26th February 2026, there was on-going negotiation between the US and Iran. Discussions mediated by Oman happened just two days prior to the strikes, where both sides described the situation as constructive, showing the fragility of the situation, even in advance to the strikes. The freeze date of the committee, February 28th 2026, is precisely the day the crisis erupted, meaning the delegates must work with the agenda to promptly manage the ongoing situation, and prevent further escalation.

contradiction, the delegate of the US pointed out Iran's continued noncompliance with compromises such as the uranium issue, where Iran continued to develop its military weapons and continued to support terrorist organizations. Israel highlighted Iran's launch of missiles as a response to Israel's alleged strike on Damascus, and although it has widely been attributed to Israel, they have claimed no accountability. This was followed with a Point of Order from Iran stating that both the presidents of US and Israel, did in-fact publicly accept the strikes. The delegate of Iran framed their retaliation as lawful self defense under Article 51 and states it will continue until the aggression fully stops.

The second session commenced with a moderated caucus regarding maritime security in the Strait of Hormuz. US pointed out that the IRGC is not under Iran, and is a terrorist organisation, yet its actions affect multiple nations. In agreement to US, the delegate of UK also made similar points, calling out Iran and stating that they cannot defend this as an act of lawful self defense. Despite being repeatedly called out by multiple delegations, the delegate of Iran offered no substantive rebuttal, further deepening the committee's already flatlining energy, leaving much to wonder about how the next sessions would proceed.

*Written by Tanvi
Photography by Ruthva*



The committee began with opening statements from various delegates, the delegate of France emphasized the need to suspend offensive military operations, release of unfairly held hostages and restore affected civilian areas. The delegate was posed with a POI from Israel which they abstained from answering, proving that their over reliance on AI, although effective for preparing for an impressive speech, has shown diminishing returns in terms of original arguments and authentic thought processes. In



United Nations
Security Council

Day 2

The 3rd session opened with a second GSL, where Iran framed its retaliation as lawful self-defense under Article 51, stating it would continue until the aggression fully stopped, and clarified that it was targeting only U.S. military assets and bases in the region - not the sovereignty or civilians of Gulf states. Iran also rejected the JCPOA snapback mechanism, calling out the UK, France, and Germany for having no legitimate grounds to invoke the deal's dispute mechanism, since they had violated it first by keeping unilateral sanctions in place. The UK responded that Iran had struck Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and the UAE, and argued that Article 51 self-defense doesn't exempt a state from the requirements of necessity and proportionality. The UK further called out Russia for defending Iran's sovereignty on principle while its conduct in Ukraine undercuts that same principle, and criticized China for continuing to purchase Iranian oil in violation of an embargo it had helped establish in 2015, despite claiming to respect council resolutions. Despite these call-outs, no rebuttals or responses followed, raising questions about delegates' preparedness.

Interviews with the UK, Iran, and Israel afterward offered further insight. It was asked why the UK still claimed to want diplomacy revived when the U.S. ended talks by striking Iran instead, and what it's actually doing beyond calling for negotiation. The UK delegate said that while allied with the U.S., they do not condone the violence and have positioned their navy outside IRGC territory in case of suspicious activity. Iran's responses, by contrast, were unclear and combative, offering little to build on.

The 4th session opened with a small, humorous crisis - President J. Donald Trump renaming an airport to "Donald Jade Trump Airport" via "spectacular voting results," gave the committee a laugh to start the day. Before resuming the previous session's moderated caucus, the EB announced a shift from UNSC to General Assembly format, allowing former observer states to become present delegates - leaving veto-holding delegates visibly caught off guard. The EB cited the lack of engagement in prior sessions as the reason for the change. The caucus topic, de-escalation of the Middle East crisis, saw China cite legalities without making particularly effective points, though it did suggest a UN-facilitated regional dialogue and de-escalation framework to bring regional stakeholders together ahead of conflict, rather than only responding after the fact.

After the moderated caucus, the EB allowed submission of SPA's, and after receiving internal feedback from the EB, they confirmed their disappointment in the delegates. They stated a lot of wasted potential and time went on session 1 and 2, yet they were pleasantly surprised by some unexpected delegates making valid points in their speeches.



*Written by Tanvi
Photography by Ruthva*



Day 1

AGENDA: Discussing the future of a NATO collaboration

FREEZE DATE: 20th January 2026

MAJOR COUNTRIES: US, UK, France, Germany, Italy, Canada, Turkey

The agenda for this session was to discuss the future collaboration of NATO with the freeze date set to be 20/01/2026, the day the president of the United States of America met the Secretary-General of the United Nations for Arctic security, and the day that Greenland was annexed by the USA.

The session began with Luxembourg's emphasis on the requirements of a more productive use of resources and its sharing to more needy countries, seconded by Belgium, who highlighted the requirements of more resources for smaller states in terms of defence. The delegates mainly presented modern issues facing the alliance, such as cyber attacks, rising geopolitical tension, instability and that lack of safety in the regions surrounding their nation - Italy and Lithuania affirmed this with Bulgaria's proposition to increase naval cooperation and Turkey proposed a "Southern Shield Mechanism" to strengthen NATO'S defence in the Baltic sea and the Middle East. The delegates widely supported the idea of a stronger NATO, and yet the ideas to achieve it differed.

One of the main topics of discussion was about the defence of all allied nations. Several countries, such as Slovenia, Latvia, Germany, Poland and Bulgaria, all levied that the defence budget should increase the amount of money given by each country to help more defenseless countries. Certain countries presented their ability to increase their budget, but it was opposed by some, citing a high stress on fiscal expenditure. Hungary proposed, to much dissent, that an increased military budget will be insufficient alone, but would be better for use in improving infrastructure and citizens' welfare.

Another dominator of the debate was the discussion of the need for improved cybersecurity and increased innovation. Luxembourg wanted the integration of artificial intelligence in the defense projects of NATO, to modernise the military. Although the United Kingdom, Finland, Sweden, Portugal, Denmark, Lithuania, and Bulgaria concurred, they mainly focused on better cybersecurity, intelligence sharing and the proposal of critical infrastructures, such as the underwater optic fibre cables.

The most controversial debate was about the US

annexation of Greenland; the US delegate stated that Denmark had under invested in Greenland's defence and infrastructure and had claimed that Greenland is vital for Arctic security.



During the unmoderated caucus, an interviewee claimed that Denmark's governing of Greenland originated through colonialism and stated that the United States could help develop Greenland's infrastructure, early-warning systems, and NATO's Arctic naval presence. The discussion on Greenland's sovereignty yielded many varying opinions from a mix of Scandinavian and European countries.

*Written by Dwarak
Photography by Divyan*



Day 2

Proceeding from earlier events, 4 resolutions were proposed: a Swedish-Spanish proposal with amendments, Lithuania's objective, Norway's consultation and Slovakia's consultation.

The Swedish and Spanish delegates put forth a working paper, proposing burden-sharing (where nation size correlates to contribution), cybersecurity, and security in the Baltic region. The paper aimed to boost cooperation and strengthen the alliance's collective defense capabilities. Support for the proposal was minimal, and it was ultimately turned down.

Norway put forth the "High North Intelligence Fusion" directive, proposing the High North Intelligence Fusion Cell (HNIFC) as a specialized branch of the NATO Intelligence Fusion Centre in the Arctic region, aimed at increasing information coordination and military awareness in the area. The paper called for coordinated ISR operations to monitor hybrid threats, suspicious maritime activity, cyber incidents, and risks to critical undersea infrastructure, with findings reported regularly to the North Atlantic Council to enable quicker military response and broader decision-making. The HNIFC would operate on the NIFC's existing cyber infrastructure, integrating with current networks without a separate digital framework. Following heavy rebuttals, the paper gained ample votes to pass in committee.

acknowledging allies' economic limitations. It received support from Bulgaria, Turkey, the United Kingdom, Luxembourg, Slovenia, Hungary, Norway, Lithuania, and Latvia. Despite this, the paper failed to pass after lengthy deliberation.

Finally, Lithuania's delegate proposed strengthening NATO's forward defenses and military mobility in the Baltic region. The paper highlighted Lithuania's strategic positioning between Kaliningrad and Belarus, emphasizing the importance of the Suwałki Gap as the key land route linking the Baltic states to NATO. It argued that NATO's current Enhanced Forward Presence battle-groups were insufficient to respond independently to a large-scale attack, and cited weak regional transport infrastructure as a barrier to rapid troop movement. To address this security risk, Lithuania called for a stronger regional military force, supported by air power and missile systems, along with investment in transport infrastructure, standardized rail networks, and pre-positioned supplies to improve readiness at this bottleneck. Following debate, the proposal failed to pass the committee 32-1, with 0 abstentions.

After a slow, yet constructive session in NATO, these directives showed some deep deliberation from certain powers, proving that while this year's NATO delegate pool can yield some improvement, they managed to bring forth interesting proposals that effectively solidified their alliance.

*Written by Dwarak
Photography by Divyan*



Slovakia's delegation presented a proposal addressing the struggles smaller nations face meeting NATO's rising defense demands. It argued that while Slovakia had been strengthening its military, the pace of expansion required under the Rapid Adoption Action Plan placed significant financial strain on smaller member states. The proposal called for an increase in Slovakia's military capacity, including additional personnel and equipment, to strengthen its contribution to collective defense while



United Nations
Economic and Social
Council (ECOSOC)

Day 1

AGENDA: Addressing economic instability in commodity-dependent states with relevance to recent geopolitical tensions

FREEZE DATE: none

MAJOR COUNTRIES: JAPAN, GERMANY, US

ECOSOC gathered to deliberate on the agenda, "Addressing Economic Instability in Commodity-Dependent States with Relevance to Recent Geopolitical Tensions." The committee comprised 48 delegates, of whom 33 were first-time participants, making this a primarily beginner committee that shaped the overall quality and direction of debate.

Discussions aimed to address the vulnerabilities faced by commodity-dependent economies amid ongoing geopolitical tensions, focusing on diversification strategies, trade resilience, and multilateral cooperation. However, the substantive quality of debate was significantly affected by a high dependency on AI-generated content; resulting in multiple delegations adopting positions that did not align with their nations' actual foreign policy stances — including proposals to partner with countries or organizations with which they currently hold diplomatic or economic disputes. Consequently, the lack of proper research led to repetition, with multiple delegations presenting near-identical resolutions rather than distinct, country-specific approaches.

The session opened with The General Speaker's List, where countries spoke on their stance, most of them mentioning whether they were just for or against, followed by an enlightening explanation on the agenda. After a few speakers, the floor was open for motions, a moderated caucus on whether commodity-dependent states should prioritize export restrictions to encourage domestic industrialization. Notably, major economies such as Japan and Germany remained largely silent throughout the debate, offering minimal input despite their significant stake in global trade and commodity markets. Their limited engagement reduced the diversity of perspectives and valued discussion expected from economically influential nations.

The Philippines and the IMF (International Monetary Fund) representatives both opposed export restrictions, citing the importance of maintaining fiscal neutrality and global competitiveness. The EU supported a consistent regulatory approach, while the UAE of-

fered a middle ground, endorsing restrictions without outright blockades. Argentina was questioned in its export restrictions 2001–2002 on soybeans that aided the country out of a debt crisis, arguing that export restrictions, if implemented, must be transparent and should apply to raw materials rather than finished goods, ensuring critical infrastructure remains unaffected amid geopolitical tension. China faced significant scrutiny after delegates pointed out contradictions in its position: while promoting BRI-linked debt repayment through raw material exports, China simultaneously encouraged already indebted nations to seek further loans from the IMF and World Bank, despite its historically strained relationship with these institutions.



The medley of ideas offered by the delegates allowed the committee to move forward in terms of setting the foundation for building their resolution in the upcoming sessions.

*Written by Devna
Photography by Shreyathi*



United Nations
Economic and Social
Council (ECOSOC)

Day 2

The subsequent session featured notable interventions addressing debt vulnerability arising from commodity market disruptions. The United States proposed the R.I.S.E. framework — restructuring loans with clear terms, mobilizing private investment to reduce reliance on volatile state debt, embedding Shock-Absorbent Clauses into loan agreements, and pursuing diversification away from single-commodity dependence. It was later amended to prioritize healthcare financing.

Opposing this, Thailand argued that if even a disciplined economy had little room to borrow, commodity-dependent exporters had none. It blamed Russia and the U.S. for eroding trust in existing mechanisms, citing Russia's collapse of the Black Sea Grain Initiative and continued U.S. obstruction of IMF quota reform. Thailand proposed an automatic debt standstill upon entry into a relief program, followed by a creditor deadline, after which an independent IMF-World Bank panel would impose terms, alongside a qualification tier for commodity-dependent states hit by verified shocks.



Tanzania was criticized for demanding another nation lower its interest rates despite global market constraints. Zambia proposed a sovereign wealth fund, and the IMF representative faced pushback for reiterating ineffective proposals, later conceding this shortfall. Bangladesh raised concerns over LPG issues tied to treaty obligations with India, alongside its \$5.5 billion IMF loan. Though the IMF itself flagged endemic corruption and governance failures within the country's financial system.

In light of these divergent stances, the resolutions spanned several competing approaches. Bolivia proposed an OPEC-style cartel for lithium and

other tech minerals, sitting uneasily alongside its recent pivot toward market-friendly reform. Indonesia, Chile, Kenya, Bangladesh, and Nigeria pushed for export bans to encourage local refining, while Venezuela, South Africa, Mozambique, and Argentina proposed price-linked bonds — a mechanism Argentina itself had pursued, resulting in prolonged prosecution with vulture funds and exclusion from credit markets.

Zambia, the UAE, and Senegal proposed sovereign wealth funds despite Zambia having only recently emerged from its own debt restructuring. Brazil, the Philippines, Ukraine, Qatar, and India called for regional emergency and poverty funds, while Canada, Germany, India, and the World Bank pushed to reform the IMF's Compensatory Financing Facility, tying liquidity to benchmarks reminiscent of the Structural Adjustment Programs of the 1980s and 90s.

China, Australia, and Japan jointly proposed infrastructure-led industrialization and transport corridors, undermined by China's own extractive lending record and unresolved debt standoffs with Zambia and Sri Lanka. Malaysia proposed export openness and sustainability protections, complicated by its history of palm oil export restrictions.

Ultimately, several resolutions relied on countries advocating positions inconsistent with their recent conduct, alliances, or capacity — reflecting the pattern of miscommunication and underprepared stances that defined the session.

*Written by Devna
Photography by Ruthva*



Day 1

The chairpersons briefed the reporters on the rules and regulations along with the expectations set upon them. Among these, the chairpersons explained the linguistic details that were crucial to their articles, such as avoiding contractions and using British English for spellings. In addition, the reporters were also instructed to avoid plagiarism and the use of AI, as well as the expectation to meet deadlines and stay unbiased about the issues.

With the ground rules established, attention then turned to the assignments themselves. The reporters were expected to submit 3 articles: the opinionated editorial, the beat article, and a creative reportage. Alongside these, they were also expected to write a timeline article.

Starting with the first of these, an op-ed (opinionated editorial) is a piece where the writer shares their personal views on an issue and supports it with facts, examples, and reasoning. It aims to spark thought, encourage discussion, and persuade readers to see the issue from a particular perspective.



Next, a beat report gives readers a clear and unbiased overview of what happened in a committee. It focuses on the most important discussions, decisions, or turning points while keeping the reporting factual and free from personal opinions.

A creative reportage, meanwhile, is a detailed, fact-based article that explores a specific issue or event in depth. It focuses on explaining the topic through research, real-world context, and engaging storytelling, helping readers understand its causes, impact, and human significance while remaining objective.

Finally, a timeline is a visual or written overview of the

most important moments in a committee, arranged in the order they happened. It highlights key events, discussions, and turning points while briefly explaining their significance and avoiding unnecessary procedural details. On this point, the chair explained that reporters are to arrange the events of the day in chronological order for the timeline.

Later in the day, the chairperson Varshini gathered the reporters to inform them about the upcoming press conference. As part of this briefing, the reporters are allowed 5 follow-ups and were asked to avoid open-ended questions, opposing which they were to ask targeted questions that force an honest response from the delegate. Following this they were also asked to not focus on the decision made but on the reasoning behind it - such actions, as it was noted, show the true signs of a journalist.

Following the press conference, at 4pm in the evening, the reporters were expected to assemble for the final discussion of the day, during which, despite the earlier warning, the chair had noticed an increasing use of AI in the articles, urging them to complete their reports and submit it within the deadline.

*Written by Gayathri
Photography by Shreyathi*



“Speak your mind
even if your voice
shakes”
~ Maggie Kuhn





Day 2

Day 2 of the conference began with the chairpersons giving an important briefing, bringing all the reporters together to go over the schedule for the day and remind everyone about their deadlines. This meeting was a way to check progress and get ready for what followed, making sure all the reporters knew what was expected of them for the rest of the conference. The chairpersons also talked about the press conferences happening that day, so reporters could get their questions ready for the committees they were covering.

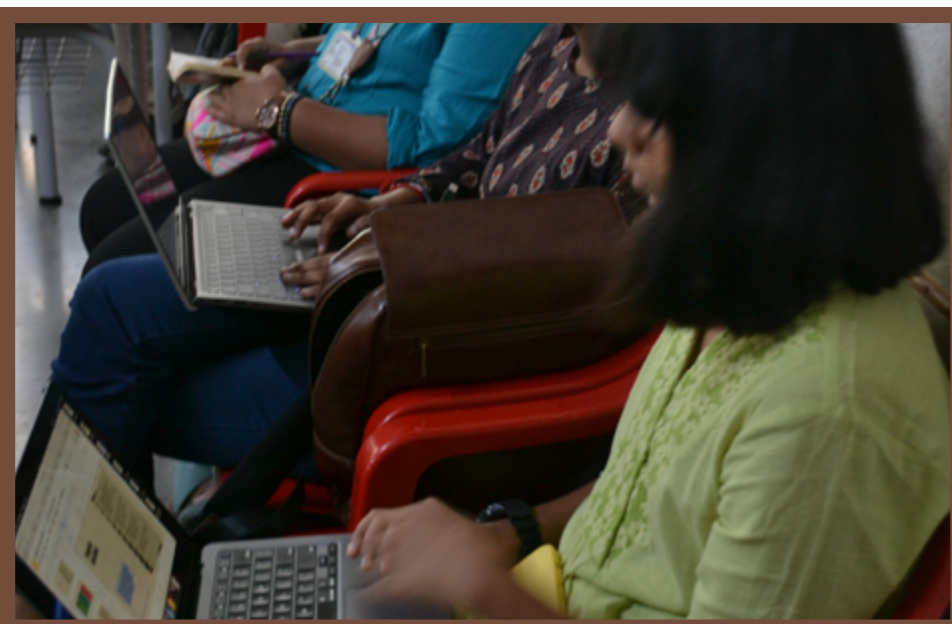
By the start of Day 2, reporters had already finished some main tasks from the day before. They had written their beat article, an opinionated editorial, and a creative writing assignment. These all required them to utilise their creativity, precision and accuracy. With those done, they now needed to focus on two more assignments: a creative report and a conference timeline. Both were due by the end of Day 2, so managing time was very important for everyone.

The first press conference started right at 10:00 a.m. and was with the North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO) committee. Reporters showed up with their notebooks and laptops, ready to get information and ask questions to the delegates. Even though the conference offered good chances to learn about what the committee was discussing, many reporters found it hard to ask good, clear questions in the pressure of a live setting.

The reporters stayed back in the press room to work on finishing their writing assignments, while they waited to attend and lead the press conferences for the committees they were covering. This helped them stay on schedule with their deadlines without compromising on the quality of their work.

As Day 2 went on, reporters juggled covering committee meetings, meeting their deadlines, and getting better at interviewing. The day was both busy and educational, providing useful lessons in professional journalism and getting participants ready for the rest of the conference.

*Written by Gayathri
Photography by Ruthva*



Only a few reporters managed to ask questions that were clear, to the point, and well-organized, which led to helpful answers from the committee members. Others seemed unsure or hesitant, missing chances to talk with the delegates. This experience showed how important it is to be prepared, confident, and think quickly in journalism, especially at formal press conferences where time is limited.

Best Awards

UNITED NATIONS HUMAN RIGHTS COUNCIL

Best Delegate: Eesha Vijay, Cuba	Best Debutant: Siddhanth Adhavan, El Salvador
High Commendations: Harshini Vennapusa, Malayasia	Special Mentions: Nityaa Sree Kasi Viswanathan, Algeria

UNITED NATIONS ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL COUNCIL

Best Delegate: Ishadeep Mahapatra, Russia	Best Debutant: Hamsine Shanker, Argentina
High Commendations: Rathi Vijay, Thailand	Special Mentions: Eshan Balamurugan, USA

NORTH ATLANTIC TREATY ORGANIZATION

Best Delegate: Keerthi Lakshminarayanan, USA	Best Debutant: Akhil Arunkumar, Lithuania
High Commendations: Kezia Sharlyn Dhaya Sharmila, Norway	Special Mentions: Lekisha Sharma, Spain Sahitra Biswas, Turkey

UNITED NATIONS SECURITY COUNCIL

Best Delegate: Advait BVS, Iran	Best Debutant: Ishaana, Nigeria
High Commendations: Hiya Ashish Bongirwar, Algeria	Special Mentions: Liya BR, UK

INTERNATIONAL PRESS CORPS

Best Reporter: Vedika Mahendran	Best Photographer: Gary Edwin
Best Debutant: S Sahana Sriyaa	Best Debutant: Arvind Narayanan
High Commendations: Shraddha Rajesh	High Commendations: Joseph Antony
Special Mentions: Disha Krystal	Special Mentions: Ishaan Javok Ajay

From the Editors



When I was offered this esteemed position, I was an amalgamation of emotions. Be it the jitters I had the night before, or the exhilaration to be spearheading this newsletter, I have learnt a number of things. It began with the knowledge that when you unite with like-minded, passionate individuals, the results of the work you do together is truly beautiful. The results, which are in your hand, are a convergence of accomplished writers, keen-eyed photographers, and a tight-knit team spirit.

Despite a number of technical difficulties in the days leading up to this weekend, we all pulled through. And it couldn't have been done without the relentless backing of a number of amazing people from our teachers- Shirley ma'am who helped immensely in editing the Gazette, and Nandhini ma'am who patiently read through the painstakingly long reports- and to the Secretariat and EB, who meticulously planned this event and lent us a quota of their resilience to put together a comprehensive recount of all the events.

But most of all, if it weren't for our articulate and accomplished writers who stayed from the start till end to ensure that their reports were rich with details, such a high quality piece couldn't have made it here into your hands. And without acclaiming our masterful photographers who captured moments that were seen and unseen alike, this note is incomplete.

I extend a heartfelt thank you to the school management who entrusted us with this immensely rewarding task, and the opportunity to experience something I never have before and these experiences have translated into memories I'll never forget.

In conclusion, we all hope you enjoyed reading this as much as we did making it (but trust us, there was plenty of stress involved too).

- Bhruhati

Photographers

Ruthva Harish
Divyan
Shreyathi

Reporters

Hariny R M
Devna Prasad
Gayathri Chandrasekar
Dwarak Hariharan
Tanvi Hariharan

Designers

Shreyathi

Editor-in-Chief

Bhruhati